

TYPES OF MISCARRIAGES

Different terms are used to describe miscarriage, depending on what is found during an ultrasound scan or an internal examination.

- **Threatened miscarriage** is the term given to bleeding early in pregnancy, but in which the cervix remains closed. In this case, the bleeding stops after a few days, and the pregnancy is likely to continue.
- **Inevitable miscarriage** occurs when there is bleeding and the cervix is open, meaning that the fetus will be lost. If the pregnancy is less than eight weeks, the bleeding may be like a heavy, painful period. After eight weeks, the bleeding may be considerably heavier.
- **Incomplete miscarriage** occurs when there is bleeding and the cervix opens, but the uterus doesn't expel its entire contents and some pregnancy tissue is left behind.
- **Complete miscarriage** is when there is bleeding, the cervix opens, and the uterus expels all the pregnancy tissues.
- **Missed miscarriage** occurs when there may not be any bleeding or cramping but the pregnancy stops developing and the miscarriage isn't diagnosed until the routine scan at around 12 weeks.

LATE MISCARRIAGE

Losing a pregnancy after the first trimester is much more unusual than an early miscarriage. After 20 weeks, a pregnancy loss is referred to as a stillbirth. There are several reasons why late pregnancy loss may occur, including infection, uterine abnormalities or abnormalities in the baby, and a weak cervix. If you have a late miscarriage, your doctor will discuss the possible causes with you and, if a cause is identified, whether anything needs to be done in a future pregnancy.